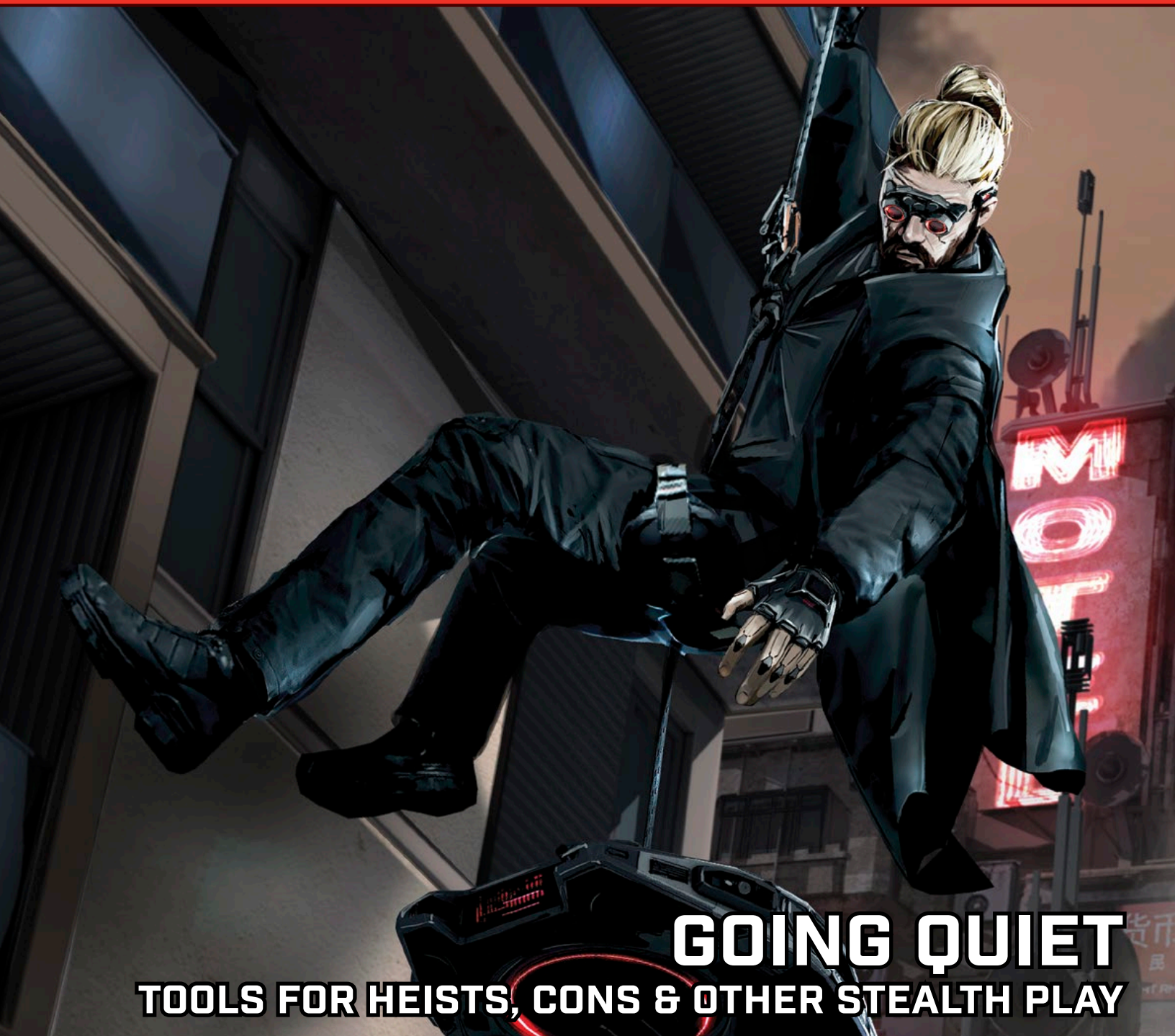


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DATA

24/7's investigation into missing cargo began in the *Did Someone Say Murder?* DLC.

Measure Twice angled his periscope and peered through it, down towards the sidewalk below. There it was, hovering outside a window. A Mark 2 Proctor. Concept Mechanics manufactured it exclusively for Ziggurat, and yet this drone lacked Corporate branding entirely.

"You sure about this, Toofer?" he said, subvocalizing so only his throat mic would pick up the words.

Across the street, 24/7 watched the scene through his camera.

"Not entirely," The Media admitted, "We know reports of unmarked drones flying around the Heywood Docks hit the Data Pool at the same time cargo started going missing. We know one was flying around the area the night Barry called me. Might be a coincidence ..."

"... but there's no such thing in investigations," Measure Twice finished, "Right. Going down."

As a Solo, Measure Twice specialized in quiet precision. He tugged on his line, twice, to be sure it was secure on both ends, then climbed over the lip of the roof. Slowly, he descended toward the hovering drone, a bit at a time.

"Torch insists the Proctor has a blind spot," 24/7 said into his ear, as Measure Twice lowered himself down, "So long as you're right above it, it won't spot you."

Measure Twice peered into the same window that the drone was watching.

"Doesn't matter," He subvocalized, "Drone's runner is probably too busy watching the couple slamming inside to notice me."

Still, he was careful to stay directly above the drone, moving with practiced, smooth precision as he tucked a tracer into a crevice in the Proctor's casing.

"Done," Measure Twice reported, "Going up."

24/7 snapped one final picture of the drone before stowing away his camera.

"Meet you at the van."

From there, they would track the drone to its operator. Find the next link in the missing cargo investigation chain ... and get justice for Barry. Whoever was behind the cargo scheme flatlined the poor dock worker while he was on

the phone with 24/7, trying to slip him information. He vowed to Barry's ghost that he would find the answers and hold them up to the daylight for all to witness.

And 24/7 was a man of his word.

STEALTH OPERATIONS

Not every part of every mission involves loud guns and explosions. Sometimes, a crew needs to go quiet. Maybe they're breaking into a Neocorp's HQ and don't want to bring a hundred Corporate cops down on their heads. Maybe they're running a con or pulling a heist. Whatever the case, autofire, massive linear frames, and grenades aren't always the answer. That's what **Going Quiet** is all about.

We've broken this article up into three sections. The first is **Flash of Luck**, an optional ruleset first published in **Tales of the RED: Hope Reborn**. It helps prevent "planning paralysis" by allowing Players to spend Luck and retcon a past event into existence. Next, **Stealth Netrunning**. You read that right. We're finally providing Netrunners the rules they need to slip through a NET Architecture undetected. Finally, **Harry the Shrimp's Gear Guide** is a selection of equipment curated especially for stealth ops by a legendary grifter.

Stealth runs might be hard ... but they're damn fun. Good luck, choomba!

FLASH OF LUCK

In the real world, leaders spend an astonishing amount of time planning missions, attempting to account for every contingency. In a TTRPG, that can get boring quickly, leading to a whole session (or more!) spent planning for action instead of taking action.

Flash of Luck gives Players a safety net, allowing them to spend Luck Points (**SEE CP:R PAGE 130**) to retcon a past event into existence, providing an advantage when the unforeseen occurs. This new rule helps prevent heists, infiltration, and con jobs from transforming into hours-long planning sessions or absolute disasters due to not anticipating one specific element of the gig. It might be too powerful to use during more combat-oriented missions, so GMs, feel free to only allow the use of this rule when you feel it adds to the game and doesn't unbalance it.

DATA

Like Flash of Luck, Harry the Shrimp first appeared in *Tales of the RED: Hope Reborn*.

THE RULES

The rules are as follows. Refer to the Flash of Luck table for specific guidelines on building a flashback.

- A Player can only use Flash of Luck once per Beat and no more than three times per Mission.
- Performing a Flash of Luck is a Standard Action if done during combat.
- The Player must spend Luck Points as indicated on the Flash of Luck table and then describe the action they took in the past, tell when it occurred, and explain how it helps in the current situation. Players still need to spend the appropriate amount of money and succeed at any Checks needed to make the action viable. If they cannot buy the item in question (due to GM fiat or the economy rules), they get their Luck Points back. If they fail Check(s), the Flash of Luck still occurs, showing they tried the action but failed — they cannot try again. This

counts against the number of times the rule can be used per Beat/Mission, and the spent Luck is not refunded.

- GMs always have the right to veto a Flash of Luck if they feel it is too powerful or impossible. For example, you can't slip sugar into the gas tank of a car you couldn't have known would be in the race, and no amount of prep will let you hide a standard sniper rifle in your Rockerboy's skintight bodysuit.

Example: A security team has cornered Racer (played by Kennedy) and Torch (played by Isaac) in a Corporate facility. Kennedy says, "We can both see in the dark. I wish there were a way to turn off the lights so we can get an advantage." Isaac slides 2 Luck Points over to the GM and states, "Outside in the alley, before we slipped into the building, Torch jimmied open a control panel and hardwired a remote control device into the wiring. When I tell Beatrice, my Agent's pseudo-AI, the codeword, she'll activate it, and the lights will shut off."

► FLASH OF LUCK

Type: Guidelines for building the Flash of Luck, complete with examples.

Maximum Spending: The highest amount of much money an Edgerunner can spend during a Flash of Luck at this level. This includes the cost of gear picked up, bribe money paid out, and so forth.

Luck Point Cost: How many Luck points the Flash of Luck costs at this level.

Type	Maximum Spending	Luck Point Cost
A simple task/coincidence that could have easily happened "on camera" during a previous Beat. Examples: You called a friend from your Lifepath and arranged for them to be in a nightclub you're about to infiltrate. You picked up an Air Pistol at a Night Market you visited last session.	100eb	2
An unlikely task/coincidence that could not have happened "on camera" during a previous Beat. Examples: The security guard you encounter is a regular in your regular Wednesday night poker game (even though you've never mentioned the game before). You've hidden an assault rifle behind a cabinet in the nightclub you're sneaking into (even though you've never been there "on camera").	500eb	4
An improbable task/event requiring remarkable foreknowledge or incredible luck. Examples: You were a beta tester for the safe model you're trying to crack, so you know how to exploit its weaknesses. You once ran into the club owner at a casino where he displayed a serious (and exploitable) gambling problem.	1,000eb	8

The GM agrees with the idea but tells Isaac to spend 100eb for the remote control device and to make a DV15 Electronics/Security Check to be sure Torch pulled off the wiring job. Isaac rolls a 17 total, and Torch clears the DV. Torch shouts out the codeword, and the lights blink off.

STEALTH NETRUNNING

Successfully pulling off a Netrun without being detected is all about maintaining stealth across multiple obstacles in a NET Architecture. Mechanically, you'll need to successfully Quietly Jack In to establish stealth, and Evade Detection from any Black ICE, Demons, and Netrunners you encounter in the Architecture for the duration of your run.

JACKING IN ... QUIETLY

To establish stealth in a NET Architecture, you have to spend an additional NET Action when you Jack In. When you do, you roll a contested Interface Check (Interface + 1d10 vs Interface + 1d10) against all **Watchers** (Demons, enemy Netrunners ... and other entities with an Interface Rank) currently in the Architecture. If you beat them all, you successfully establish stealth and enter the system undetected.

Example: Redeye wants to stealth her way through a small Corporate facility's NET Architecture. There are two Watchers currently in the system: an Imp Demon and a Corporate Netrunner. Redeye's Player rolls Interface (4) + 1d10 (8) for a total of 12. The GM rolls for the Imp (Interface [3] + 1d10 [7] = 10) and the Corporate Netrunner (Interface [4] + 1d10 [2] = 6). Since Redeye beat them both, she goes undetected. Neither the Imp nor the Corporate Netrunner knows she Jacked In.

BENEFITS OF STEALTH

Being stealthed in a NET Architecture allows a Netrunner to operate as they would normally, with the benefit of being able to avoid combat and preventing Watchers from sounding an alarm. However, there is one major limit: taking possession of a Control Node always breaks stealth. Leaving Viruses and stealing lucrative Files are fair game, though if you leave a flashy Virus, you'll obviously draw attention as soon as it activates. If you're smart, by that time, you'll be out the door ... or better yet, long gone.

BREAKING STEALTH

When stealth is broken, all Watchers in a NET Architecture become aware of the Netrunner's presence, and all Black ICE react to them as they normally would.

BLACK ICE AND STEALTH

When a Netrunner encounters a Black ICE while in stealth, they roll Interface + any bonus to Cloak Checks + 1d10 vs the Black ICE's Perception + 1d10 instead of performing a Speed Check.

If the Netrunner is successful, the Black ICE does not spot them and doesn't enter the Initiative Queue at all. Stealth is maintained. If the Netrunner fails, stealth is broken, they suffer the effect of the Black ICE as if they failed a Speed Check, and the Black ICE jumps to the top of the Initiative Queue. A Black ICE unaware of a Netrunner due to success at stealth does not count as "encountered" if that Netrunner is unsafely Jacked Out.

Example: Redeye encounters an Asp on the third floor of a NET Architecture. The GM calls for an opposed Check. Redeye's Player rolls her Interface (4) + the Cloak bonus from an active Eraser Program (2) + 1d10 (3) for a total of 9. The GM rolls the Asp's Perception (4) + 1d10 and gets an 8. The GM describes the Asp peeking up its head for an instant, tongue slithering in and out of its digital mouth as it looks slowly around the floor, before sinking back to rest. Redeye stealths by to the next floor.

WATCHERS AND STEALTH

When a Netrunner encounters a Watcher, a quiet battle of Netrunning ability takes place. The Netrunner rolls Interface + any bonus to Cloak Checks + 1d10 vs the Watcher's Interface + any bonus to Pathfinder Checks + 1d10. This does not take a NET Action for any participant. If the Netrunner is successful, stealth is maintained. If the Netrunner fails, stealth is broken.

On their Turn, a Watcher in the same NET Architecture as a stealthed Netrunner can use a NET Action to make a Pathfinder Check and search for hidden enemies. They can only do this once per Turn. To do this, they roll Interface + any bonus to Pathfinder Checks + 1d10 vs the stealthed Netrunner's Interface + any bonus to Cloak Checks + 1d10. If the Watcher is successful, stealth is broken.

It is up to the GM to determine the location of a Watcher in a NET Architecture, but in general, Netrunners like to hang out on the bottom floor, and Demons stick close to a Control Node.

Example: On the floor below the Asp, Redeye encounters an Imp sitting in a Control Node. Redeye's Player rolls Interface (4) + the Cloak bonus from an active Erase program (2) + 1d10 (10 + 5) for a total of 21! The GM rolls the Imp's Interface (3) + 1d10 (2) for a total of 5. The Imp is unaware of Redeye.

During the next Round, the Corporate Netrunner sitting on the bottom floor of the NET Architecture performs a search, looking for infiltrators. The GM rolls the Corporate Netrunner's Interface (4) + the Pathfinder bonus from an active, Tech Upgraded See Ya program (3) + 1d10 (9) for a total of 16. Redeye rolls Interface (4) + the Cloak bonus from an active Erase program (2) + 1d10 (5) for a total of 11. The GM describes a blue pulse of light scanning the floor Redeye occupies. The blue pulse of light pauses, then shifts to an angry red before racing back down the NET Architecture. Stealth is broken. The jig is up!

REESTABLISHING STEALTH

Once stealth is broken, the Netrunner must Jack Out and Quietly Jack In again to attempt to re-establish it. You can't unsound an alarm, though, so the damage may already be done. If you're trying to hide from an enemy Netrunner after they caught you just a few seconds earlier, the GM is perfectly within their right to assign your Netrunning stealth Checks a penalty (SEE CP:R PAGE 130).

HARRY THE SHRIMP'S GEAR GUIDE

You want to know what gear to grab for your next heist? Tell you what, buy me some giggle water and I'll give you the skinny. I may be out of the game, but I still keep up with the latest improvements in quiet tech.

▶ BINARY COMPOUND

Cost: 50eb (Costly) per tube

A classic thief's tool, upgraded by tech for the modern age. The tube comes with two nozzles. Each nozzle expels a chemical that, while harmless on its own, combines with its mate to create a nasty compound capable of eating through anything.

It takes 6 seconds (2 Rounds) to apply the Binary Compound to a 2 m/yd by 2 m/yd section of cover. Once it is applied, the Compound begins damaging the targeted section of cover at a rate of 6d6 damage per Round. If the cover is layered, the Compound continues to eat through the next layer of cover once it is done with the previous layer. Binary Compound becomes inert and no longer does damage 18 seconds (6 Rounds) after it is applied.

▶ BRANDED JUMPSUIT

Cost: Variable

Forget Ghostsuits. The easiest way to keep invisible in most surroundings is to look like you belong. Get the right color jumpsuit fitted with the proper patches, and most people won't even give you a second peep.

A jumpsuit or similar uniform identical to those worn by a specific organization's construction, janitorial, food service, or other crew members. The cost depends on the security of the organization.

- Low Security (convenience store): 50eb (Premium)
- Moderate Security (construction site or hospital): 100eb (Expensive)
- High Security (smaller Corporation): 500eb (Very Expensive)
- Extreme Security (Megacorporation): 1,000eb (Luxury)

▶ CONCEALMENT SLEEVE

Cost: 500eb (Very Expensive)

You've got to sneak into a Corporate joint and extract a target. For that, you'll need weapons and tools. You might be thinking, if the gear's inside my chrome, security will miss it, right? Wrong! Plenty of Corps shell out for cyberware detectors at the front door. There's a solution, though. Find a Tech with the right skills, and they'll fit a Concealment Sleeve over your cyberlimb. Then you can walk through with no problem.

A special sleeve, fitted over a cybernetic limb, containing ultra-thin emitters wrapped in sculpted RealSkin™. When wearing a Concealment Sleeve, a user's cyberlimb reads as biological to a cyberware scanner. Each sleeve must be custom-fitted to a specific cyberlimb. Once fitted, a sleeve cannot be adjusted to work for any other limb.

DATA

Occasionally in **Cyberpunk RED**, cost doesn't equate to how easy it is for a Fixer to get their paws on something. An item or service might be pricey but easy to get or cheap but hard to get. In such cases, the cost and the price category can be different.

► HANDPRINT GLOVE

Cost: 500eb (Very Expensive)

You infiltrate enough secure joints, you'll run into a handprint scanner eventually. The technology's old and unreliable compared to modern security measures, but also cheap ... and Execs sure do love cheap!

A glove made from Realskinn™ imprinted with a specific handprint (including fingerprints). While the glove will fool a security scanner, it will not leave actual prints behind on surfaces. Each Handprint Glove must be custom ordered, and the print being duplicated must be provided to the Tech making it.

► HANDPRINT SCANNER

Cost: 20eb (Everyday)

To make a Handprint Glove, you need a record of someone's handprint. With your Agent, it's duck soup. That means easy, kid. You can scan the hand itself, or blow some fine particulate matter onto prints left behind on a smooth surface, and scan that instead.

App. To record someone's handprint directly, the user must be in Melee Range and do nothing but scan a target's exposed hand (palm side) with the App for 9 seconds (3 Rounds). This time need not be consecutive. Scanning a target for a Round is an Action and requires the user to succeed at a DV13 Brawling Check. If the target is unconscious, bound, or otherwise unable to move, the user succeeds at this Check automatically.

The user can also scan prints left behind on smooth surfaces. If the print in question is complete (the whole hand pressed down on a surface), this only requires one scan. Otherwise, the user must compile the target's handprint from at least five different prints. Each time the user scans a print, they must succeed at a DV13 Criminology Check to capture it for use.

► LASER MICROPHONE

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

A surprising number of buildings in Night City still have glass windows. Don't know why. Those things are a security hazard and outside ain't that glam, anyway.

Laser Mics generate a beam of amplified light (aka a laser) that can be aimed at a pane of glass up to 300 m/yds away. Once the beam is set, the device

reads the vibrations in the window caused by sound in the room beyond, then translates them into audible noise and conversation for its user. The Microphone's laser is normally invisible but can be seen if it travels through mist, smoke, fog, or similar substances. Laser Mics can read vibrations from Thin Bulletproof Glass but not Thick Bulletproof Glass.

► MILITECH M97 GHOSTSUIT

Cost: 5,000eb (Luxury)

This sort of thing ain't for me, but I know snipers and a few thieves who swear by it. Ghostsuits are full-body coveralls incorporating liquid crystal displays, fiber-optic digitization systems, and mini-camera technology. It scans your surroundings, then changes to match it and make you as close to invisible as modern science can manage.

When the user remains still for 1 minute (20 Rounds), they can activate a cloak that hides them from all visual senses, including Low Light/Infrared/UV, unless the perceiver succeeds at a DV17 Perception Check. Activating the Cloak does not require an Action. The cloak is deactivated automatically if the user moves further than 2 m/yds (1 square) within 3 seconds (1 Round).

► NYMPH PERFUME

Cost: 500eb (Expensive) per bottle

Back in the 2020s, Biotechnica claimed their Nymph Perfume line would "stimulate the sexual centers of the brain" via special pheromones. Turns out that was a bunch of baloney. The perfume's just a mild, aerosolized euphoric. Still useful in a con, though. Just make sure it don't work on you, capisce?

A spritz of Nymph Perfume lingers on a surface for 1 hour. Anyone who spends more than 9 seconds (3 Rounds) within 6 m/yds of the perfume's source must succeed at a DV13 Resist Torture/Drugs Check or become slightly confused and take a -2 penalty to Human Perception Checks for 1 hour. A person who wears the perfume is considered to be within 6 m/yds of themselves for this purpose. Sufficient protection, such as Nasal Filters or an Anti-Smog Breathing Mask, prevents inhaling the perfume. Nymph Perfume is considered a drug for the purposes of administering Rapidetox (**SEE CP:R PAGE 150**). A full bottle of Nymph Perfume contains 50 spritzes.

▶ PARABOLIC MICROPHONE

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

A classic, beloved by private dicks who specialize in divorce cases. Set up shop across the street, then record the cheaters talking dirty while they feed each other fruity SCOPballs at a local cafe.

Parabolic Microphones amplify sound coming from a specific direction, allowing the user to hear from up to 30 m/yds away as if they were directly next to the source.

▶ PROFESSIONAL DISGUISE KIT

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

Changing your mug is essential in this line of work, and that requires a good disguise kit. The technology has changed over the years, but it's all still make-up, padding, and RealSkinn™ prosthetic appliances. Sure, you can spring for Biosculpting, but that eats into your budget fast.

Using a Professional Disguise Kit adds a +2 bonus to Personal Grooming Checks to appear as someone else. There are limits to how far an appearance can change without Biosculpting or expensive special effects. No Disguise Kit can add or subtract more than a few inches from your height or fake five extra, fully functional cybereyes in your forehead.

▶ RETINA LENS

Cost: 500eb (Expensive)

Even in the age of cyberware, a lot of Corporations use retinal scanners to lock high-level doors. It ain't uncommon for big-time Execs with cyberoptics to imprint their old biological retinal patterns on their chrome to avoid the hassle of upgrading the locks.

Overlays a fake retina pattern on the user's eye, allowing them to fool some forms of security. Each Retina Lens must be custom ordered, and the pattern being duplicated must be provided to the Tech making it.

▶ RETINA SCANNER

Cost: 50eb (Costly)

Of course, to make a Retina Lens, you need a retinal pattern first. Back in the day, you needed an expensive, specialized device to scan someone's eye. Now, you just need an app and an Agent.

App. To record someone's retinal pattern, the user must be in Melee Range and do nothing but scan a target's exposed eye with the App for 15 seconds (5 Rounds). This time need not be consecutive. Scanning a target for a Round is an Action and requires the user to succeed at a DV13 Brawling Check. If the target is unconscious, bound, or otherwise unable to move, the user succeeds at this Check automatically. Users with Internal Agents can record retinal patterns, so long as they also have MicroVideo installed in a Cybereye or Smart Glasses.

▶ TRANSLATION CHIP

Cost: 1,000eb (Very Expensive)

Install: N/A

Humanity Loss: 7 (2d6)

Raven Microcyb just released these swanky things onto the market. Real-time translation devices. As you see or hear words, the chip translates into the language of your choice and projects that text onto your chyron.

Chipware. Requires Chyron. Any words in a language heard or read by the user are translated into a pre-chosen language and displayed on their Chyron as subtitled text in real time. At the GM's discretion, uncommon "dead" languages or languages and dialects spoken by small and/or isolated population groups aren't translatable by the chip. Translation of slang terms is hit or miss, as language evolves faster than Raven Microcybernetics can push out updates. The Translation Chip does not allow the user to speak any additional languages.

▶ ZETATECH TANK COMMANDER HEADSET

Cost: 100eb (Premium)

When you're trying for a clean sneak, sound's your enemy. Nothing like having your radio squawk when you're hiding under a desk, waiting for a mark to walk away. Grab a stealth headset. Throat mic picks up sub-vocals, so they won't hear your voice. Earbud cancels noise, so they won't hear your mate's voice, either. Zetatech makes the best one, in my humble.

A wrap-around throat microphone and attached earbud that can be linked wirelessly to any Agent or radio. Detecting sound going into or coming out of a Stealth Headset is impossible without some form of Amplified Hearing.